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Editor's Note

Dear Reader,

"Time is relative," Einstein said. As was the case in many of his ground-breaking scientific theories, Einstein appears to be right again. It seems only yesterday that I ventured into the mountains of Sosa, filled with apprehension but giddy with excitement. Yet, just this February, KMLA has greeted its new batch of freshmen for the 21st time.

One might say that 20 years is a long time; others, short. Throughout its history, the school has had its ups and downs, its continuities and changes. We created a three-branch student government from scratch. The Code of Student Conduct evolved from a six-page manual to a 24 page monstrosity. Although we are definitely not perfect, it is undeniable that KMLA pioneered the trend of leadership education in Korean high schools. It's amazing how far we've come in two decades.

In this edition, Minjok Herald attempts to commemorate this milestone in our school's history. Perhaps this is an opportunity to briefly pause our breathless race, step back, and take in the general landscape of our achievements and failures. How different are we from our school in 1996? Where will we be twenty years from now? To answer these pivotal questions, Minjok Herald analyzes changes in curriculum, morning exercise, and school uniform to examine the trace of time in aspects of life that all waves – from the first to the twentieth – shared. We also reached out to our alumni who graduated more than ten years before, glimpsing what "post-KMLA life" is like.

Though it seems like we will forever be high school students, it is a truism that we will one day graduate this very unique institution. We will leave Sosa, but KMLA will remain. As many of our alumni remark, however, the unforgettable experiences that students accrue here draw us back to school after graduation. When we revisit this school as adults, we hope to see the continuance of beautiful traditions while being pleasantly surprised with improvements.

It is perhaps too early in my term to be thinking of successors, but I hope Minjok Herald will also be such an existence. To be a trustworthy yet interesting source of news and opinion. To be alive and active as a creative body open to change. The past is the past, and the only way is forward. May we all prosper.

Ahn Se-Bin
Editor-in-Chief
March 1st, 2016

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The 1st Wavers in orientation



The 1st Entrance Ceremony



1st Wavers in class



1st Wavers in class



The 1st Graduation Ceremony



The Completion Ceremony for 1st Wavers headed to KAIST



FESTIVITY, or an Embarrassment?

On September 5th, 2015, one week before the Sooneung, the 2015 Sooneung(KSAT; the Korean equivalent of SAT)/SAT Party unveiled its curtains on the 12th floor of the dormitory. The Sooneung/SAT Party is a party designed to encourage the seniors so that they would be able to show their full potential on the Sooneung, also known as the K-SAT, and to wish the best results for their college applications in both international and domestic fields.

The main event of the party is delivering "rolling papers," papers on which students write short comments about the student who will receive the said paper. The seniors are called up one by one, and the hosts of the party would deliver the rolling papers and presents for each senior. The rolling papers were prepared several weeks before the party by the Department of School Event Management, and students, varying from freshmen to seniors, left messages on them before the party. In addition, different presents were prepared for each student based on an anonymous survey of recommendations from their peers.

> "Even if the majority is entertained, the minority who is emotionally injured should not be completely ignored."

The party went on as planned. During the delivery, seniors with related stories were called up one after another, as if to narrate the seniors' three years in KMLA. The party heated up as the presents were revealed one by one. The presents were relevant to events or the character of each senior. Although the allusion was not specifically mentioned, most of the seniors in the room knew what the presents were referring to, as they have been living as a family under the same roof for three years of diverse experiences – there were no secrets amongst the crew.

Although the party was generally appreciated, there were numerous criticisms. First, the timing of the party was somewhat inappropriate. As the party was held just before the Sooneung, some domestic field students were not able to attend. A wide gap in quality and price among the presents dissatisfied many as well. However, the biggest criticism was on some unpleasant presents. A majority of seniors agreed that some presents recalled painful memories, creating an intimidating atmosphere. For example, some presents alluded to past romantic relationships or faded negative reputation. An anonymous senior commented, "Seeing my friends emotionally suffering, I felt that some revision to the party might be necessary. Even if the majority is entertained, the minority who are emotionally injured should not be completely ignored." Several seniors even left in the middle or avoided attending the party.

To address the issue, the chief of the Department of School Event Management proposed several reforms to the Assembly of Representatives. The suggested options were as follows: replacing the party with another party such as a Halloween Party, retaining the party but changing its format, and holding it at the start of the 2nd semester. 20th waver Lee Jae-Jun advocated retaining the party, saying, "The date and the methodology are the problems. As long as we revise the method, the party is worth keeping." On the other hand, 19th waver Moon Chae-Yun took an opposing stance: "The purpose of the party is ambiguous. Considering the time and effort poured in, the party seems unnecessary and inefficient." At the end of the debate, all twenty-two representatives voted that the proposals should be passed down to class councils for voting, unanimously recognizing the need for a reform.

19th waver Gwak Min-Kyung, the chief of the Department of School Event Management, said, "I thank the seniors for their enthusiastic reaction. I apologize if the party hurt anyone. Regardless of the results, I hope that the seniors remember that the party was prepared and held out of our sincere wish for their success."

Yoon Ji-Hoe
Staff writer, 19th Wave

HOW EBS CAPTURED KMLA

From October 26th to 31st, 2015, a camera crew from EBS visited KMLA to cover the daily lives of KMLA students. The program wanted to capture KMLA's "passion," and was broadcast on November 30th and December 1st with the title "Self Documentary, School." They stayed for 5 days, and filmed every moment of KMLA's daily routines. While the cameramen used the Residence Hall during their 5 days visit, they were seen at many sites of the school from very early in the morning and late until midnight. Many students exposed their way of living and were interviewed by the crew on various things.

The students were quite excited about the visitors that captured their ordinary lives which seemed dull during most times. While the students gathered altogether at the cafeteria on November 30th and December 1st to watch the program, they all enjoyed finding each other in the documentary. The 10th grade domestic students' English vocabulary test was closely viewed, as the whole test procedure, starting from the test preparation to the interview about the results, was filmed. Chicken Day was also filmed, taking up one of the longest broadcast time. The camera crew visited one of the girls' rooms and pictured the unaffected scene of 6 girls eating chicken, sharing their anecdotes of the week and their own worries.The documentary even showed the aftermath of leftover chicken, which was traded through Facebook. During the weekend, a cameraman followed two girls on their way to Sosa Service Area. The whole sequence of relishing the outside food was vividly captured.

"It concentrated too much on how students enjoyed eating chicken and 'Sosa food'."

Of course, the students' daily routines were broadcast as well. The student court, which was held at the gym due to the enormous number of participants on Thursday, was recorded. Students who did kendo for morning exercise could see these men filming their unified kendo movements. The crews were frequently seen at the cafeteria to film the food and the students eating it. The scene of Special Training was recorded, too, as the special training participants were closely interviewed on the reason why they were not wearing their school uniform. Last but not least, the crew was invited to almost every class of the school curriculum and interviewed many students.

However, the 5 days were not totally satisfying to everyone. Many said their visit was quite unexpected and so sudden. But as Mr. Choi Gwan-Young, Deputy Headmaster of Educational Planning asserted, since the school and the crew wanted to capture the most natural appearances of the students, the news didn't have to necessarily be delivered so urgently. However, it is difficult to expect that students would behave naturally in the looming presence of a camera lens directed at them. Another complaint came from some girls, as male cameramen visited the girl's dormitory to see how students study at night.

The students' reactions after the airing were diverse. Most of the students giggled while watching the documentary, but still some were dissatisfied at how their school appeared on television. Compared to the past EBS documentaries about KMLA, this one depicted KMLA as an overwhelmingly hilarious place. Rather than showing how students enjoy learning about complicated subjects, voluntarily participate in various aspects of school autonomy and club activities, and retain their own profound objectives towards life, it concentrated too much on how students enjoyed eating their chicken and 'Sosa foods.'

Still, many students gathered at the cafeteria and watched the documentary with enthusiasm. If a student doing an interview was on the screen, regardless of how close they were to the interviewee, everyone was intrigued to see their humorous comments and somewhat beautified testimonies made in front of the camera. They also found their daily routines very interesting from a 3rd person point of view. The documentary was on everyone's lips for several days after the airing.

The school as a whole was in a buzz to see the visitors and paid close attention to the documentary. Although some aspects were quite uncomfortable, it was a new experience for students to rethink how they seem to outsiders. But most importantly, it was indeed very refreshing to see themselves and each other on television.

Choi Hee
Junior writer, 20th Wave



RULES AND VIOLATIONS; *the Scarlet Letter*

"Using computers is limited for academic purposes only. Watching videos and playing games are prohibited. Violators will be accused to court, and the laptop will be taken for a month as punishment." This is a direct quote for the computer regulation in the Code of Student Conduct, designed to restrict inappropriate computer usage. These days, however, the number of its violators has set a new record. The number of violators in 2015 increased greatly compared to those in 2014. During the boy's honjeong on October 19th, dormitory supervisor Mr. Kim Dae-Ki announced that the computer regulation will be strengthened by adopting a new policy called The Scarlet Letter. "Due to the continuous increase in the number of computer regulation violators, I have decided to reinforce the regulation," he said.

Before this policy, some violators borrowed spare computers from other students to hand in to the dorm parent instead of their own, so that they could still use their original laptops during the one month take-away period. Of course, this is punishable conduct, so the procedure was carried out secretly among students. It seems that this leeway has caused students to no longer take the regulation seriously, resulting in an increase in violations. The new policy, "The Scarlet Letter," was suggested mainly to prevent this tacit process. Basically, it bans the use of any computers on dormitory desks where a violation has been caught. To mark these violators' desk as no-computer zones, a special sign called "The Scarlet Letter" was designed by 18th waver Koo Ja-Seung. The name originated from Nathaniel Hawthorne's novel *The Scarlet Letter* because of the similarity in its method of punishment: showing that the bearer of a symbol is a "criminal." From now on, when a student gets caught violating the computer regulation, this sign would be attached to the seat, and the student would no longer be able to use a computer there. Introducing this new policy, Mr. Kim mentioned that the violators keep repeating their mistakes and do not take their punishments seriously.

> "NAGA," a "business" page that lends spare computers and collecting cash for its daily fee, has disappointed many KMLAians.

Still others also claim the need for strengthened policies. During the student court held on November 5th, Ms. Jeong Seon-Hui mentioned that she was deeply disappointed by the students who borrowed spare computers from others – or even lent them as an actual business. In fact, a few weeks before the court, a newly created Facebook account called "NAGA," a profit-geared "business" page, was created to lend spare computers for a daily fee. Such occurrences disappointed many KMLAians, and the account was deleted shortly after. Ms. Jeong criticized that lending or borrowing a spare computer contradicts the goal of the computer regulation. Indeed, the act definitely has to be stopped. Considering this, the intent of the new policy is understandable.

It is true that there is a sudden increase in the number of exposed computer regulation violators this year compared to previous years. The numbers are undeniable proof. Therefore, it is not completely out of the blue that the dorm parent has come up with a new idea to prevent students from using their computers inappropriately. However, the actual effectiveness of "The Scarlet Letter" policy is difficult to forsee. The policy hasn't been enacted yet, and as many have pointed out, there are plenty of areas in the dorm where a student can use computers out of the dorm parent's sight. But it is too early to affirm that the implementation of the policy is a futile attempt. We shall have to wait and see.

Cho Sung-Min,
Junior writer, 20th Wave



The Love-Hate Relationship between KMLAIANS and Expletives

"If I speak more about this, I'm going to end up swearing!" were the words uttered by Mr. Kim Myung-Soon during a recent morning assembly, when he spoke about the language use of KMLA students as of late. In particular, he spoke of their frequent use of expletives in their speech, and his concerns about how it would impact the school as a whole. Ms. Son Eun-Ju also spoke out, talking about her experiences spotting students spitting out expletives; stating her beliefs that recently, students have become more careless in their word choosing.

"I spoke in such a way because I feel like our students are not behaving like proud, honorable KMLA students. I hope that this serves as a chance for them to think about their responsibility and the pride that they should possess," explained Mr. Kim in an interview a few days later. He also spoke about the harm this kind of crude language would bring; if important guests visited the school and came face-to-face with the students' abominable language, KMLA's image would be severely damaged.

This outburst came as a surprise to some students, as there have been no issues with the students' language usage (other than the constantly troubled EOP) before. The majority of students tend to use expletives in their daily speech without much consideration, although the extent to which they do so varies wildly. Some students do not feel remorse for, or even notice, their use of profanity. One student said, "I habitually swore at myself in the lobby of Dasan Hall, and had to clap my hand over my mouth because Ms. Kim Kyung-Joo, who was passing by, called me out for it."

In general, however, most students agreed with Mr. Kim's thoughts: there was a serious need for the use of expletives to cease or at least relent a little.

The 20th wave in particular was under fire. In the morning assembly that followed the one which Mr. Kim had spoken out about the students' language use, he addressed the 20th wave students separately. He expressed his disappointment in their crude language, which he believed was inferior to those of their seniors. His powerful statements were met by a diverse array of opinions from the 20th wavers. One student said, "I think our use of expletives is very problematic. It is wrong to continuously use expletives when we do not need to." Another said, "I do not think expletives are bad at all. Expletives now serve as interjections or point-stressers." Some other opinions were that Mr. Kim was generalizing the actions of a small number of students, or that a campaign should be started to deal with this issue. In general, however, most students agreed with Mr. Kim's thoughts: that there was "a serious need for the use of expletives to cease or at least relent a little."

But the 20th wavers were uncertain about the remarks that were made towards their language use as a wave compared to the others. When asked in a survey whether they thought they swore more compared to the other wavers, over 50% of the students replied that they did not really know. Approximately 35% thought that the 20th wavers did have a problem with their language use. When asked to rate the amount they swear regularly on a scale from 1 to 5, the number of students who rated themselves with a 5, or "swears regularly in normal life" was four times the number of students who rated themselves with a 1.

It is pleasant to note, however, that the 20th wavers are not apathetic about their problem with language. Over 80% of the 20th wavers replied that they knew their swearing habits could bring negative effects. Additionally, about 75% replied that they were currently trying to correct their language; although unfortunately, far more students experienced difficulty in doing so than those to who experienced improvement.

It is unfortunate that many feel that the language of KMLA students has deteriorated to a level where they think it would damage the school's reputation. However, it is clear that many students are aware and making an effort to improve. It is a mercy that there is a good chance that things will not continue to deteriorate. As Mr. Kim said, "One's use of language can affect one's impression greatly. I hope that as a person, and as a student of KMLA, our students try to improve their speech."

Lee Yung-Seo
Junior writer, 20th Wave



FEATURE

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To commemorate the 20th anniversary of KMLA, the feature has focused on the "changes" over the past two decades. Since its foundation in 1996, the school has undergone numerous changes in terms of its schedule, uniform, and morning exercise. As you review these changes, we hope that you get a sense of what it was like to be a KMLA student years ago. We also contacted several alumni to offer some insight into post-KMLA lives and experiences in the real world. Enjoy hearing from the alumni about how KMLA has influenced and possibly shaped their characters and their lives after KMLA.

TRACES OF TIME: CHANGES IN MORNING EXERCISE

Lee Yong-Hun
Junior feature writer, 20th Wave

"Morning exercise is very much like our school days. Although it is tiring, it will become another piece of our precious memory after we graduate from KMLA," said 19th waver Jung Dong-Hyun.

"Morning exercise brings out the sleeping beauty in all of us," said 19th waver Seo Min-Ki.

Morning exercise has been made mandatory for all students since the foundation of KMLA in 1997. It aims to develop a balanced body and mind and to enhance a student's concentration. The founder, by introducing morning exercise, tried to encourage students to get up early in the morning and eat breakfast. The history of morning exercise can be divided into three distinct periods; before the building of the gym, pre-2000 and post-2000.

1996 - 1997 (Before the building of the gym)

Until the gym was built in the second year of school, students were very limited in terms of the types of exercises and sports they could enjoy. The options were meditation, Korean calligraphy, and archery. Every morning, students participated in different exercises following a rotational cycle. Teachers who stayed in dormitories were required to participate in morning exercises, as well.

1997 - 2000

The construction of the gym led to some groundbreaking change in the morning exercise program. New programs with emphasis on stretching and light-exercising, such as Gichaejoe (spiritual exercise), Danhakgi sureon (Tai Chi Qigong exercise), and Taegeukgigong (similar to Qigong exercise), were added. Non-P.E. teachers were also called to supervise students during morning exercise. Despite the increased variety of the programs, students were no longer given the freedom of choice. Instead, all students participated in the same program which changed three times a year as different teachers took the role of the program director.

After 2000

Since 2000, morning exercise program has changed dramatically. The term was shortened from eleven months to nine months, considering the harsh weather condition. The length of the exercise was also reduced from fifty minutes to thirty minutes because of tight scheduling and the increased hours of regular P.E. classes. P.E. teachers became the directors of morning exercise. Different programs were introduced for different grade levels. For example, today, freshmen can choose between kendo (Japanese martial arts) and taekwondo (Korean traditional martial arts), while juniors have options of jogging, Korean archery, soccer, volleyball, and basketball. Meanwhile, the seniors move on to either the National Health Gymnastics course or traditional archery.

TRACES OF TIME:

CHANGES IN "A DAY IN KMLA"

Kim Hee-Jin
Junior feature writer, 20th Wave

1996

The schedule was a six-day routine, not divided by the days of the week, but called A day and B day. This set would be repeated two times without break, followed by two days of weekend. However, the weekends were frequently cancelled, and the normal classes were continued. In truth, there would be ten days of summer and winter vacation each, five days of Chuseok and New Year's Day break, leaving only a month of break during the whole year.

Within one day, there was morning exercise, four periods of morning classes, lunch, and thirty-five minutes of mandatory nap time. Then, there were another four periods of a class, dinner, optional nap time, and self-study. The self-study time went under various changes, from longer periods before KSATs, to full time classes. When students took mock KSATs once a month, self-study was made mandatory until 3 am starting from a week before the test. Teachers would roam the corridors of the dormitory until 3 am to check on the students. Students had to study until 3 am and wake up as early as 6:20 am. Only on the day before the test would they be allowed to go to sleep early.

1997

All-English classes were introduced. To enhance the students' English skills, the school mandated students to take three years' worth of English classes in a year, resulting in 20 hours of English classes a week. The Korean teachers also had to be taught English by the foreign teachers. However, teaching only in English was quickly changed from mandatory to optional.

1999

The founder decided that students would be better taught by teachers than by themselves and replaced self-study periods with classes until midnight. Such classes were soon expanded to the weekends, as well.

2000

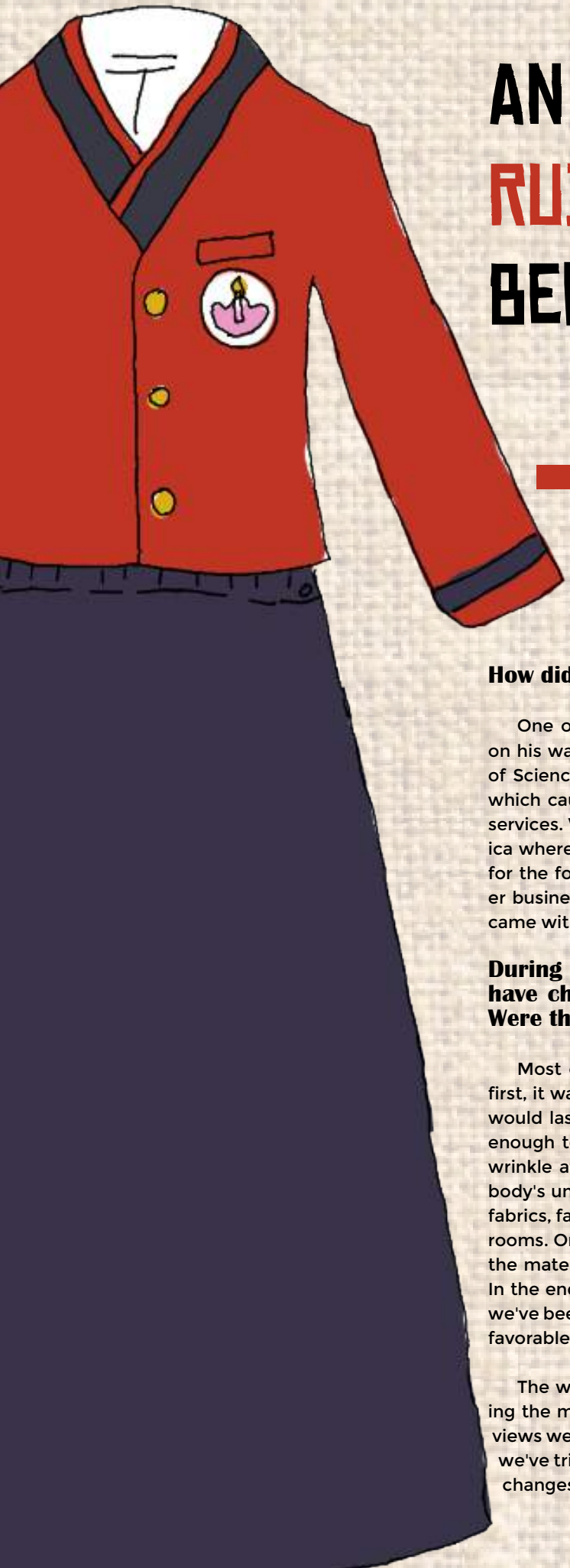
Until this time, a student and teacher assembly was held every Friday on the 11th floor of the dormitory. It would start with a court and end with a teacher's meeting attended by students. After one of these assemblies, the founder left the school for personal reasons. Afterwards, all nighttime classes that had replaced the self-study periods were abolished. Also, the school adopted a fixed, systematic student schedule.

2004

The school introduced the Global Leadership Program for Students (GLPS), resulting in longer vacations in order to fit in the three-week camp. Summer session was implemented around this time. It started off as a 5-week program and took some time to stabilize into the current 3-week system. Meanwhile, IR classes were introduced. 2004 was also the year that wireless Internet was introduced across campus.

2007

The government mandated all schools to make all Saturdays class-free. As a result, classes were reduced and assemblies and reading classes were pushed back to Saturdays. The gradual reducing of classes on Saturdays came to today's schedule of wholly class-free Saturdays in approximately five years.



AN INTERVIEW WITH RUDIA. THE HANDS BEHIND OUR UNIFORMS

Chang Suh-Won
Staff feature writer, 19th Wave

How did Rudia come to be responsible for KMLA's uniforms?

One or two years before the founder established the school, he was on his way to give a lecture to what is now the Seoul National University of Science and Technology. He happened to pass by Rudia's main store, which caught his eye. Since that fateful day, he has been requesting our services. We've made hanbok for the Pasteur workers, sent some to America where the founder's wife had been staying, and made various designs for the founder himself. He was someone who didn't overlook the smaller businesses and constantly supported them. Later in 1996, the Founder came with his own designs and asked us to make the uniforms.

During the past 20 years, the materials for the uniforms have changed several times. Why were the changes made? Were there requests from the school or from the students?

Most of the changes were for the summer and autumn uniforms. At first, it was mostly trial-and-error: we had difficulty finding a material that would last for three years, be light enough for the heat, yet comfortable enough to wear. Some of the initial materials we used would shrink and wrinkle after wash. There were times we had to redo the entire student body's uniforms because of this. Over time, we settled on using polyester fabrics, favorable for wash by water as is provided by the dormitory laundry rooms. Once we got complaints that the fabric was too itchy and changed the materials to one with more cotton, but that ended up being too hot. In the end we changed the fabric back to the polyester one. The material we've been using since last year is the one that has been receiving the most favorable responses.

The winter uniforms haven't changed much. We've attempted changing the materials once in the past, one that had more cotton, but the reviews were bad. After that, we've kept the materials fairly uniform. Overall, we've tried to incorporate as much student and parent opinions regarding changes in the uniforms as possible.

How do you decide on the designs and color for the uniforms each year?

We don't have the liberty of changing the basic designs; they're kept as closely to the originals given by the founder without encroaching on convenience. For the girls, though, we did change the previous leaf skirt into a seamless one-piece skirt. The leaf skirts were more prone to flipping in strong winds. Also, we noticed that the girls, well, their waist sizes tended to change over the years, so we put in rubber bands for more flexibility.

For the boys, the uniforms used to be those traditional hanbok pants where the waist would be large and fixed by tying with strings. But later we put in velcro instead for convenience's sake. This year, we decided to add rubber bands like the girls' unforms.

Color-wise, we're trying harder to implement students' wishes. Like this year, we received survey results from the student council and are referencing it. In the earlier years, though, it was mostly decided through discussions with the founder's wife. Later, after the founder and his family withdrew from direct management of the school, we simply chose the colors ourselves, sometimes asking for opinions from graduates. The school doesn't restrict us in this aspect – as long as the colors aren't too garish.

What is the biggest difference between traditional hanbok and KMLA uniforms?

There's not a big difference, except that the uniforms have been modernized to be more convenient. For example, for the boys' formal dress, we use fabrics that would be used for contemporary school uniforms, not in traditional hanbok. For the girls as well, other than the dress and top, we tend to use more casual fabrics. The fabrics used for traditional formal hanbok isn't practical for constant use: they're weak to washing and heat so they rarely last three years. Other than such changes made for convenience, though, differences with the traditional hanbok are minor.

When were the hardest moments while working with KMLA?

As we mentioned before, there were times when we had to remake the entire student body's uniforms because of errors in choosing the materials. In those days we would get complaints, quite severe ones, from the parents. There were one or two... strong parents who would... complain. And about the costs as well: objectively, the clothes don't cost much. Considering that the uniforms are custom-made, it's not that costly. But since they are school uniforms, the clothes are ordered in a large quantity so the overall price becomes pretty big. So we end up getting complaints about prices. I guess these complaints are the hardest parts of working for KMLA.

Is there anything you'd like to tell the students?

There's not much, but we hope they'd take care to hang the uniforms after receiving them from the laundry room. There was this one time when a parent complained that the uniform was shrinking, which was a mystery since all the uniforms were made of the same materials and we hadn't gotten any other complaints of that manner. Basically, the problem was that the uniform was so wrinkled and creased that it seemed to have shrunk. We sent it to a cleaner and got it ironed, and the uniform returned to its original size.

Since the dormitory dries the laundry after washing them, the clothes will inevitably become creased if not hung properly. We would be very grateful if the students could do that. We've been making uniforms for the past 20 years and we feel happy whenever we see the students wearing them, but even school uniforms require proper care.



That Day When...

"In a hectic place like KMLA, every day is full of surprising, unforgettable moments. Especially for our long-term faculty, there must be a particular day you sometimes reminisce and chuckle. Could you share any episodes?"

Mr. Kwak No-Jae (P.E.)
KMLA faculty for 16 years

For me, the 16th wave was the most memorable batch of students. They were exceptionally energetic and high-spirited, always causing mischief and breaking rules. If there was one rule that wasn't broken routinely, it was that we would all help pick up tennis balls lying on the ground after class. Once, the whole class – every single one of them – forgot to collect the balls after class. Outraged by their irresponsbility, I yelled at them to come back to the tennis court and clean up after themselves. I don't think I've ever yelled that loudly since then. Later, I felt sorry for shouting at them, so I made a sincere apology. Since then, they became much more responsible and mature in how they listened to and followed my instructions.

Ms. In Su-Yeon (music)
KMLA faculty for 14 years

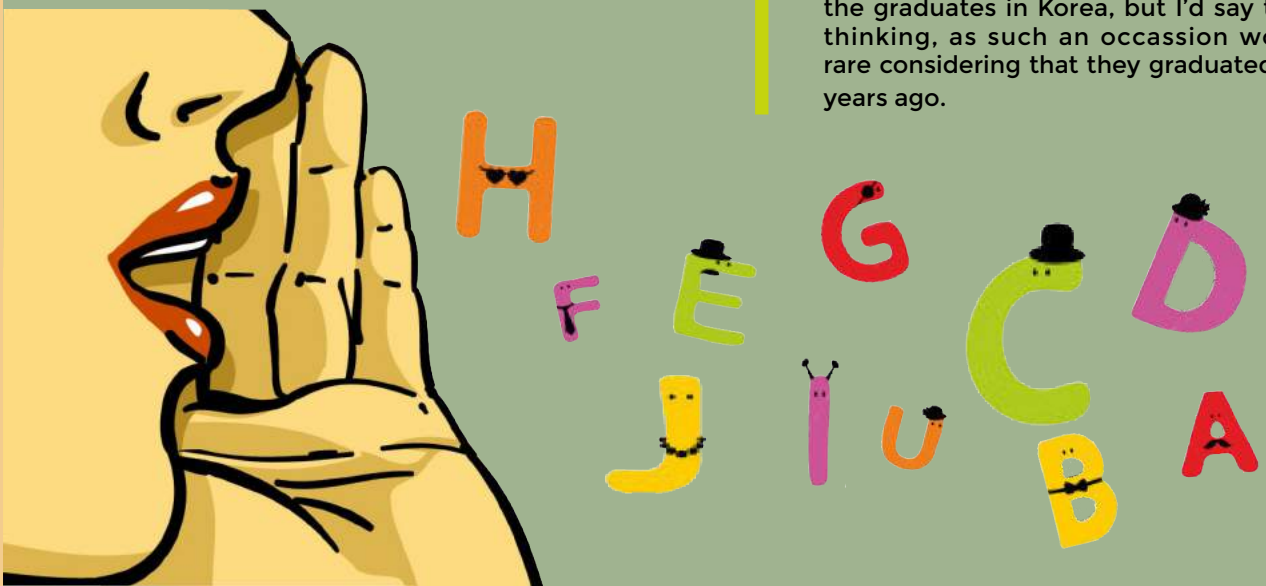
About six or seven years ago, one student struggled with learning to play the *gayageum.* Before coming to KMLA, she had never played a musical instrument, so she was slow at reading notes. She even had a bad habit of biting her fingernails, which is critical to a *gayageum* player. However, she wasn't the type to back down. She persistently practiced playing and took my classes for three whole years. Her dedication astounded me; she always carried around a portable recording device and a pocket full of artificial fingernails. I guess her persistence enabled her to make a leap from the poorest performer of the year to one of the top scorers in her senior year. Absolutely unforgettable.

Ms. Son Eun-Ju (history)
KMLA faculty for 16 years

It's mostly the students who gave me migraines that come to mind. (laugh) I don't really have a particular episode, but I still clearly remember the 5th wavers. Back in the days, we didn't have many students, so class was held in the empty lecture rooms of the dormitory, which was complete with a portable ping-pong table in the corner. We had a lot of fun thanks to that. Once we spent an entire class playing ping-pong, instead of having a lecture. I remember that another teacher was frustrated by how noisy we were and told us to be quiet. Yes, the 5th wavers were a bunch of trouble – in a good way, though. Each one of them was a professional troublemaker. On April Fool's, one student fooled almost every teacher into believing that he was transferring to another school. His friends pretended to host a farewell party for him, hugging and singing him farewell songs. Everything was so meticulously planned. Of course, I wasn't fooled – I knew that it was all a joke, but some teachers later came and asked me why he suddenly decided to transfer.

Mr. Woo Chang-Hyo (English)
KMLA faculty for 17 years

The most memorable experience that pops into mind is the vision trip to the United States. Burdened with the responsibility of a chaperone, I didn't expect myself to actually "enjoy" the trip. However, I was pleasantly surprised to find myself immersed in the fun. I especially enjoyed meeting the graduates who came to take us on college tours. Meeting students who had graudated long ago and therefore could no longer be seen around the campus was indeed a joyful experience. It would be pleasant to accidentally run into one of the graduates in Korea, but I'd say that's wishful thinking, as such an occassion would be very rare considering that they graduated ten or more years ago.



Advice from Long-Term KMLA Teachers

"Often, our academic teachers also play the role of our mentors. Is there anything particular that you'd like the students to keep in mind?"

Ms. Son Eun-Ju (history)
KMLA faculty for 16 years

I only have one word of advice for the students: never become obsessed with GPA and college admission. It greatly worries me that students, solely focused on college acceptance, will seek shallow knowledge, not an in-depth understanding of the subject. I'm worried that my classes will also become shallow as a result. Open your eyes. Look around and be aware that college admission is not everything you should live by. I hope that students become more passionate in studying not for the sake of getting accepted to a famous, prestigious college, but for the sake of learning itself – as our school motto says. I'm afraid that the passion of KMLA students which started from the first wavers might be gradually diminishing. There are a number of precious things that students can experience and enjoy only during high school. It's disappointing to see some students, busy striving for their "future goals," let those treasures of the present moments slip away through their fingers. I wish they could cherish their moments as high school students.

Mr. Woo Chang-Hyo (English)
KMLA faculty for 19 years

KMLA students work very hard. In fact, they work too hard to achieve their goals. Many of them are constantly chased by time and tight schedules. Though I respect their motivation and diligence, I see too many of them suffering from stress and insecurity. So I just want to give them one piece of advice: though you can sacrifice some of your present for a better future, you should never sacrifice too much of the present. The present is a gift, perhaps the most precious gift; yet when we have it, we are too blinded by our anticipation for the future to truly appreciate its beauty and worth. Sacrificing too much of your happiness is never wise, regardless of the reason. A successful future built on compromising the present will eventually topple. What I'm trying to say is that I want you to hold *Gwonhakmun* (Zhu Xi's text that emphasized the importance of ceaseless learning and a constant endeavor) on one hand and the words "Carpe Diem" on the other.

Mr. Eom Se-Yong (English)
KMLA faculty for 20 years

As I emphasized before, students must make their effort to become different, not the same or similar. It is, after all, the school's goal to "educate leaders of all walks of life." Each of you has different characters, abilities and future. Imitation won't guarantee your future. Break the standards and express your different abilities. I warn you, however, that this process will require courage. Being similar will provide you comfort, but will never enable you to become the true "you." The Chinese classic "Book of Changes" contains a quote of similar context. Various interpretations exist, but I think it means the following: "Change should never be a one-time event. Only when change is a procession of progress will there be true harmony." Whatever the case, do not be satisfied with the present. KMLA students should be different. Try to realize your own identity through constant effort.

Ms. In Su-Yeon (music)
KMLA faculty for 14 years

I hope you all realize the opportunities you enjoy as students at this institution. Many seem to have complaints about the administration, strict schedule, and environment, but you should always bear in mind how hard you tried in middle school to enter KMLA. There are a slew of benefits from attending KMLA: diverse extracurricular activities, rigorous courses, and the freedom of dormitory life. These are only a few things that just come off the top of my head. Things you now take for granted will one day become valuable, precious memories of high school. Once you graduate, you will probably miss this place and the time you spent here with your friends. I wish that you discover value in the things that you often overlook and learn to cherish them before it becomes time for you to leave this place.



THE CRAZY ONES ARE THE BEST ONES

"KMLA is home to many, many weird teenagers. Were there any in your wave? If there were, please recommend a particular individual and tell us something about that person!"

5th Wavers Cha Jae-Hyeong and Noh Gwan-Jin: They were the best rappers in KMLA at that time and if there had been TV programs like "Super Star K" or "Show Me the Money" back in the days, they would have participated. They always listened to hip hop music and wrote rhymes on small note cards they always had in their hands. But now one of them is just an office worker and the other is a doctor who constantly complains about working overnight. I think this just proves that people need to be born in the right place at the right time.



5th Waver Choi Ji-Woong

5th Waver Kang Tae-Ho: He is currently the representative of the 5th wave. When we went to school, there was a morning assembly every Monday at the 1st floor of the dormitory. When it was someone's birthday, a close friend would come up and say "Happy Birthday." I remember that Tae-Ho once came out and self-congratulated his birthday and made everyone laugh.



5th Waver Yun Woo-Ram

He was one of my better friends and a long-time roommate as well – let's just call him M. He was eccentric for sure, whether it be covertly flying all the way to Australia to meet his Aussie girlfriend, or singing in the middle of the night, notwithstanding his subpar vocal skills. But in retrospect it's because of friends like M that memories of life in KMLA never fail to evoke a good-hearted grin to my face.



14th Waver Song Yeong-Rae

An anonymous 11th Waver Mr. Kang: This friend would enjoy regular escapades from the dorm to the highway service station to eat udon.



11th Waver Baek In-Su

12th Waver Choi Ji-Won was one of the weirdest friends I met. When we were roommates, we both panicked the day before the exams. We ended up stacking lots of canned coffee and bowed in front of the pile, joking that we were sacrificing it to the gods – so pagan.



12th Waver Jung Jae-Won

12th Waver Kim Yeong-Yun. This friend enjoyed a rather classy, gourmet life: eating olives, brie cheese, and dried fruits in the dorm every weekend.



12th Waver Lee Da-Eun

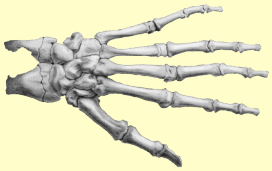


14th Waver Kim Min-Ji

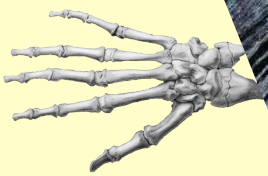
14th Waver Han Gyeong-Jae: I will never forget that time when I went to a competition with Gyeong-Jae and crossed right through the middle of the posh *Shinsegae* department store in Gangnam wearing our *noobies* (Korean word for traditional outer garment).

THE PROFESSOR SNAPES OF KMLA

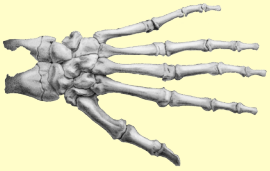
"Who was the scariest teacher during your stay at KMLA? We guarantee anonymity if necessary!"



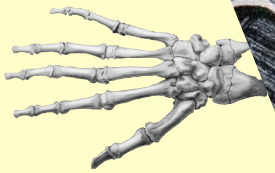
Mr. Seong Heon-Jae. I remember getting the scolding of a lifetime for being behind the archery targets while students were shooting arrows. - 6th Waver Nam Min-Ho



I would say the scariest teacher was the boys' dorm parent Mr. Kim Dae-Ki. You see, I used to enjoy poker back in my school days...and I still remember the shiver down my spine when one day, Mr. Kim suddenly glided into the room like the Dark Templar and smacked my head while we were playing poker. - 14th Waver Yoon Seo-Ho



Personally, Mr. Kim Myung-Soon was the scariest. He was in charge of student guidance, so he was obviously strict towards any violation of the school rules. Everytime Mr. Kim passed by, we would hold our breaths in timid silence. Of course, it's not because I violated the rules often... - 12th Waver Lee Kyung-Rok



Mr. Hwang Hyung-Joo. I initially thought he was scary because he punished EOP violators, along with the fact that he was the head of student guidance. But he did show us a lot of his warmer sides! He was keen on dressing up as Pooh for the Minjok Festival, and was also very amused when a certain 11th waver suggested *"jjal-ggag-i"* as the Korean substitute word for "stapler". That helped me get a lot closer with Mr. Hwang. - Anonymous 11th Waver Ms. Choi



"Food is a huge part of our lives here at KMLA. The cafeteria meals and the tradition of honjeong *bread at night become a source of nostalgia for many graduates as well. What were your personal favorites?"*

The best school meal was chicken with green onions. It was so popular that it led to a quarrel between waves. For the honjeong bread, my favorite one was the "coyota" (a flat bread with syrup inside). I loved coyota. I used to take leftovers from the cafeteria and snatch it from my friends' hands. Then I would stash them and eat them during class. - 15th Waver Park Na-Bin

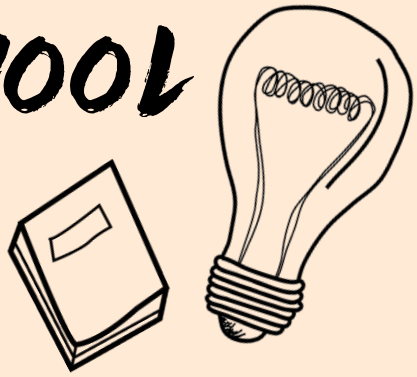
Can't pick out a single winner here. Only after graduation do you start to realize just how great the food was on a consistent basis – take my word for it. - 14th Waver Song Young-Rae

An impressive menu was the omelette filled with cheese and mushrooms. I miss how the cafeteria ladies would make them one by one and the students would form a long line to get one. For the bread, I recall enjoying the green tea chocolate brownie. My roommates shuddered even at the sound of green tea brownies, so I ate all of them. - 14th Waver Kim Min-Ji

My favorite *honjeong* bread was the pastry, for which I had to compete to secure. I would head to the cafeteria even before self-study period had ended, and secretly take five or six pastries in my bag. Of course, since a good pastry requires the accompaniment of milk, I also took a corresponding number of milk bottles. But most of the time I put the milk inside my closet and totally forgot about it, unintentionally fermenting it into cheese. Sometimes the milk even erupted from the gas, and my roommates were forced to escape to the 11th floor self-study room. - 12th Waver Lee Kyung-Rok



Memories from School



6th Waver Park Su-Hong

The 2002 Drought and World Cup Craze

In 2002, the school suffered from a devastating drought, resulting in extensive water saving campaign planned by the student council. With assistance from the Department of School Event Management and the Department of Energy Conservation and Cleaning, the student council succeeded in reducing water consumption to a great extent. Another event happened during the same year, when Korea hosted the World Cup. All the students accused by the student court were granted a "World Cup amnesty" – the first and also most likely the last case of the sorts – in celebration of Korea entering the semi-finals. Students brought samulnori instruments from the *Pung-Weol dang*, gathered together in the Dasan auditorium and supported our national team while watching the game live.

5th Waver Nam Ju-Hoon

Corporal Punishment and the Teachers' Day Flop

Despite being the president of the student council, I often violated the rules and volunteered to be punished at the student court, which used to employ physical punishment back in the days. Mr. Sung Heon-Jae, the teacher who managed the event, would take special effort to find an especially thick, sturdy cane and carry out the punishment with more force than with others.

There was also this one time when I suggested to the Founder that we hold various events instead of regular classes in commemoration of Teacher's Day. With his permission, the student council as well as most of the student body stayed up all night preparing for the events. But when the day arrived, the Founder suddenly decided against canceling regular classes and all our work was for naught.

7th Waver Kim Woo-Il

The Extinct Tradition of Summer Camp

It was nearly 10 years ago, so I can't recall the exact details but I'd say my proudest accomplishment was bringing back Summer Camp. It wasn't like GLPS, but just something casual like the entire student body going to the beach together. It had been an annual event for quite some time, but it disappeared during the previous student council's term. People had just somehow forgotten about the program. So we decided to propose bringing the Summer Camp back. Fortunately, both the teachers and the students were very enthusiastic about our idea and the camp was revived. We had a great time.

16th Waver Kim Hong-Soon

Goofing Off in the Middle of Nowhere

While going to a school like KMLA is incredibly enjoyable and memorable in itself, the experience of living in a dormitory in the middle of nowhere was what left the most lasting impact on me. Talking and studying after classes, goofing off after lights-out, wasting time in all the wrong ways on the weekends– virtually every moment I spent with my friends in the dorm was guaranteed to be entertaining and meaningful.



10th Waver Ye Chang-Wan

The Tumultuous Life of a PLZ Rascal

The most memorable performance while playing in the school rock band PLZ was the Minjok Rock Festival in 2007. It was a special experience for us because we not only performed in it, but also hosted the event, planning it from scratch to the actual show. I also remember a few chairs in the Dasan Hall auditorium broke because we had the entire crowd jumping towards the end of the night. We also made a lot of friends in bands from other schools thanks to the show.

We were rascals back in the day. I remember sneaking out of the dorm at 1 AM through the back door and spending the night in the Dasan auditorium practicing for a Christmas party performance. We ended up sleeping in the aisles of the auditorium and some freshman walked in to wake us up. Another time, Song Hyun-Beom, who was our vocalist and my suitemate in senior year, bought $60 BOSE speakers with a huge bass subwoofer. One day, we had just finished our mid-terms and turned on some music in full blast with his new speakers to celebrate. We ended up going crazy, banging our heads in the air and jumping off of our bunks. When we finally got back to our senses, we found Mr. Kim Dae-Gi standing in front of our door and glaring at us as if we were monkeys. He had to eventually come up with a new violation called "auditory disturbance" to send us to the student court and the next week, we became the laughing stock at court. Finally, I'd also like to apologize to past FITM members for stealing some of their cymbals in the past for practice.



Done with High School, Now What?

17th Waver Shin Won-Shik

Post-KMLA Life as a TV Celebrity

I rose to "stardom" through the TV program "The Brave Teenagers," which I was casted on after graduation. I think the producers of the program found my contact details via the website for a prize I was recently awarded with. The recipients' names were uploaded there for everyone to see. People from the broadcasting company began calling a publisher that I had worked with. The program writer spoke to me on the phone as well. So I was like, "Why not?" and decided to go on to the show.

During the show, viewers started to call me the "Lee Jin-Wook of KMLA" *(MH: Lee Jin-Wook is a popular Korean actor)* and frankly speaking, I felt sorry for Mr. Lee's fans! My immediate thought was, 'My friends are never going to let me live this down.' But I guess it's not a bad thing to be called after a handsome actor. So I am quite flattered.

The most difficult part of the show was that I had to sit on the same spot with full make-up for 5 hours, which was physically draining. And since I am quite a reticent person, I don't think I was helpful in making the show popular. Talking in front of cameras was scarier than I thought. I still feel apologetic towards the staff and the program writers since I behaved like such an amateur. But I was really grateful that everyone in the program was always greatly sympathetic and kind to me regardless.

12th Waver Jun Bum-Sun

The Legendary "Jun Bum-Seon and the Yangbans"

As many KMLAians already know, I pursued a serious career in music after graduation. There wasn't a particular motivation; I just wanted to be a rock 'n' roll star. My first band was called "Nom." It was me and three other friends from KMLA. I also played guitar for the garage rock band "Eastern Sidekick." That was in 2010. But then I had to go to college in the States. My band from college was called "The Shas." We were amazing. We played bluesy, jazzy rendering of alternative numbers. I miss "The Shas." Meanwhile, in Korea, "Eastern Sidekick" made it big in the indie scene. Not the least because the new members were very handsome. I really respect the band. I learned a lot from their leader, Ko Han-Kyul, in terms of how to make music, how to run a band, etc. Anyway, I was dying to come back to Hongdae, and I did, as soon as I finished college. That was in 2013. I asked Choi Hyun-Kyu, the legendary 11th wave guitarist of PLZ, to be my *Yangban* (old Korean word for gentleman). I collected a couple of other Yangbans and formed "Jun Bum-Sun and the Yangbans." There used to be another Yangban from KMLA called Jun Sang-Yong. He was 14th wave. But being a FITM, he gave up and went to law school. *(MH: The two talented school bands PLZ and FITM harbor a rivalry with long history. The opinion belongs not to the paper, but to the interviewee alone.)* We released our first full-length album last year, but I had to go to the UK to finish my master's degree. This summer, I finally returned for good. I am back with the Yangbans, and we are now working on our second album.

5th Waver Yoon Woo-Ram

The Misery of a Microsoft Smartphone Developer

I worked at Microsoft until two months ago, three years as a tester and four years as a software developer. I spent most of my time in the phone department, which was expected to compete with the iOS and the android, but is currently at the bottom of the cellphone market with the Blackberry. Therefore, when I bump into a Windows phone user, I usually am very pleased before realizing the sad truth that he/she is probably a member of the MS family.

Though fifteen years have passed since I left school, KMLA still holds a great influence on my life. Sometimes, I doubt my own ability and ask myself, 'Is it okay that I am making money so easily?' I feel the obligation to become a valuable member of our society and somehow contribute to its development. I feel attached to the country I belong to, the place I was born, and the people of my country.



Behind the Doors of the Principal's Office

Nam Hyun-Ji
Staff feature writer, 19th Wave



Dr. Yun Chung-Il first came to KMLA in March 2008 and has stayed with us for the past eight years. As he is about to leave us and embark on a new journey outside KMLA, Minjok Herald had an exclusive interview with Dr. Yun to ask him about his unique experiences here. It was not easy getting to talk with him — he rarely makes appearances in school magazines and newspapers — but it was indeed a worthwhile opportunity.

1 What was your first impression of KMLA?

That was a long time ago (chuckle).... Some of the first words that came across my mind were uniqueness and extraordinariness. I could immediately sense a different atmosphere that could not be found in other schools. The students wore hanbok instead of western-styled uniforms; back then, all students and teachers also wore *gat* (Korean traditional hat). I was impressed by the vast size of the campus and the Korean traditional architecture.

2 What are some changes you have noticed around KMLA during your 8 years here?

I think I can best answer this by sharing what I've done in the past years. The construction of *sosagwan*, the currently unused girls' dormitory, was completed under my direction in November 2013. The construction had been stopped and left there since 1994. If we hadn't completed the construction now, rain and wind would have constantly wore down the unfinished building. Now, at least it's completed, so we can leave it unused for as long as ten years – I'm sure it will soon be used, though.

Another change is that express buses now stop by Hoengseong Service Area. I contacted the Ministry of Land, Transport, and Maritime Affairs so students can take buses without having to go all the way to the Wonju bus terminal. When I first suggested this, most people thought it wouldn't work out. But see? It turned out beautifully!

Also, I was somewhat shocked by how the trees were planted with a myopic view. We must think ahead at least a hundred years (undoubtedly, KMLA will stand longer). There is a zelkova tree on the side of the pathway from Chungmoo and Dasan Halls to the dormitory; it will grow enormous and may invade the walk. That's why I ordered to pluck the trees around the dormitory and move them elsewhere.

3 Do you have any suggestions as to how KMLA can improve?

I suggest that KMLA increase the size of its student population while maintaining the student teacher ratio of 6:1. We have a large campus, but we're not making the most out of it. I also highly suggest that KMLA admit more foreign students and recruit foreign teachers. As a school that strives to join the prestigious international community and cultivate global leaders, we must increase cultural diversity.

I'd like to add one more thing: fundraising. Whereas schools overseas have tens of experts specialized in fundraising and sponsorships, KMLA has none. Philips Exeter has 50; Choate Rosemary Hall has 20. By the time we reach our fiftieth anniversary, we should have a powerful alumni association that can give us strong financial support.

4 What Are your last words of advice to KMLA students and alumni?

I'd like to emphasize that all students at KMLA are extremely gifted. Dream big. Be ambitious. Every student at KMLA has a potential to be a leader. Do not question your capabilities because you are all capable of accomplishing something big, something special.

Our new headmaster is Dr. Jeong Jin-Gon who will be joining us in March at the entrance ceremony of the 21st wavers. He majored in education at Seoul National University and studied educational philosophy at the University of Illinois at Urbana–Champaign. As many of us have noticed, his experiences appear to be very much similar to those of Dr. Yun. Hopefully, Dr. Jeong will contribute to the development of KMLA, as much as Dr. Yun has, by upholding our school's founding spirit of "Korea in heart, world in mind." We look forward to seeing new changes and innovative ideas in our school community.

50 Years Down the Road

Chang Suh-Won
Staff feature writer, 19th Wave

Since 1996 KMLA has been promoting an education system based on the principle of raising global leaders prepared for the interconnected modern society. Now 20 years into its establishment, the school looks to organize its achievements and form a new vision to accommodate to changes in and out of Korea. Thus the "KMLA 50 Year Project" is brought to light.

The research is aimed to prepare for changes in international relationships as well as the possibility of unification with North Korea, and to formulate a long-term plan for KMLA's development until 2050. By analyzing the image of future Korea, the research will provide the base for an education necessary for fostering individuals who can not only cope with the coming societal changes but lead changes of their own. The Project, a collaboration between outside researchers and KMLA faculty, can help to objectively evaluate KMLA's current status and establish the path it should take in its future.

To better understand the prospects of the Project, Minjok Herald interviewed Mr. Choi Gwan-Young, the Deputy Headmaster for Educational Planning, known to be part of the "KMLA 50 Year Project."

Q) What kind of project is "KMLA 50 Year Roadmap"?

A) The Project is aimed at discussing how the society may have changed by the year 2050 and how KMLA should develop in accordance to such societal changes. It's led by education-related professionals and research staffs of the Education Research Institute at Seoul National University. Outwardly, it's a study on how KMLA, as a Korean Global Innovation Flag School, can grow as a school for "talented global leaders" while retaining our cultural traditions.

Q) How do you feel about KMLA's past 20 years in light of the project?

A) I believe we've come a long way. Our program has stabilized significantly after a period of trial-and-error. Maybe it's not so apparent to the students, but as a teacher who has been watching the school change for the past 20 years, that's how I feel. The education program, for example, used to be unstable, but now it's almost fixed.

As the number of teachers and students increased, the school culture also grew more abundant. There's been a lot of talk and incidents. It seems hectic, but we're having generally optimistic changes; it's worse if the program becomes too fixed for improvements.

Q) Do you believe there are still ways KMLA could improve?

A) There's still a need for quantitative growth. I don't mean simply increasing the size of student body: We need to maintain the high standard and the teacher-student ratio. For KMLA to become prestigious, the number of students should reach at least a thousand so that the alumni association can hold some power in the society. As much as our educational ideals are to learn and help others, we need quantitative growth to give strength to our ideals. It would be hard to put them into action if we occupy the minority in the society.

Although KMLA is said to have the best educational process in South Korea, currently we are unsure of dynamic changes we may face in the future. We need to discuss how our education program can be improved in accordance to such changes.

Q) KMLA has now reached its 20th anniversary. How do you feel as a teacher?

A) When the school was first established, the staff worried whether we would be able to receive 11th Wavers when it was so hard just to get the 1st Wavers. Now we are looking at the 21st Wavers. As difficult as it has been, the school has developed such that our worries haven't been in vain. I also feel a certain responsibility to watch over KMLA as it continues to improve and receive the 31st, 41st Wavers.

The people who sacrificed themselves for the larger good, who gave up their own for overcoming the difficulties of society are the ones who are remembered as great men. There's a need for us to learn from their spirits and pass on their ways.

Fortunately KMLA students have more awareness of such sentiments than students of other schools, especially through Monday morning assemblies. Our national flag may be nothing more than mere paper with ink, but we are saluting the flag with our genuine respect for the sacrifices of those who protected it.

The students must be encouraged to learn and pass on their spirits. Even if the students don't become famous after graduating, I hope they will become those who can help others.



Hair Trouble

"Pursuing beauty is natural for most people."

According to article 13 of the Code of Student Conduct, KMLA students are prohibited from dyeing their hair or getting a perm. It further states that students should not put on any sort of makeup, and that those who violate this regulation would be given penalty points. Recently, however, controversy has arisen regarding the necessity and propriety of this rule. This issue was raised by the student legislative council, which conducted a survey on this issue and promised to bring its results to the attention of the teachers in the Department of Student Affairs. Most other high schools are alleviating restrictions on students' hair styles and makeup since the nationwide establishment of the Student Code of Rights; naturally, skepticism about the school's regulations has grown.

The results of the survey mentioned above were such: 74% of students out of 202 responded that school policy on hair should be loosened. These students cite students' freedom of expression as their rationale to argue that students should be allowed to stylize their hair and put on some basic makeup to cover their complexes. Pursuing beauty is natural for most people, and especially during one's teenage years, it is difficult not to care about one's appearance. Given this, enhancing one's looks through stylizing their hair or makeup can lead to a boost in self-confidence and should be allowed. Yet, Ms. Hwang So-Hee of the Department of Student Affairs has the exact opposite view. In an interview she said, "Schools ban dyeing, perm, and makeup so that teenagers can learn to accept and love themselves as they are. I want students to love their natural selves and not worry too much about outer looks, which I think is unimportant."

Whether dressing up interferes with learning is also an important point of contention. Students who ask for a looser school policy argue that hair dyeing and perm are "one-time jobs" that cannot have an impact on studying. Basically, although it may be time consuming to dye or perm one's hair, once it is done there is no further reason to spend time on it. Regarding this argument, Ms. Hwang So-Hee focused on makeup and claimed that makeup can interfere with academics. She said, "Girls who put on makeup cannot bear going anywhere without makeup so that they take time even before they go to 11th floor. Also, whenever time allows, they sit in front of a mirror and fix their makeup." Compared with those who do not worry about makeup at all, these students may get diverted from wholly focusing on their studies.

In order to come to an agreement on the extent to which makeup and hair modifications should be permitted, it is important that all students understand the rationale that the school holds behind this policy. It seems clear, considering the nationwide trend, that the students who want to get rid of this restriction or alleviate it greatly have their valid points to make. Yet it must also be noted that there are equally valid arguments in support of these regulations. Especially considering how KMLA is a school, in which values like self esteem and academic rigor are given heightened emphasis, arguments in favor of regulations must be understood well by the student body. Only then will fruitful conversation between the students and the school regarding this issue truly begin.

Yoon Jung-Chan, Hwang Jae-Won
Staff Writers, 19th Wave



"The Problem Always Lies in the Low Participation"

How to Listen

Jung Sang-Min, Junior Writer, 20th Wave

According to the Articles of Student Autonomy, the process of making a change on the Student Autonomous Rule can be summed up into three steps: Assembly of Representatives, the Class Assembly, then again back to the Assembly of Representatives. This process, flawless and innocent at first sight, actually harbors quite a plethora of problems that was hinted at throughout the semester.

Just look at the Assembly of Representatives. The role of the Assembly is to judge bills submitted to the Legislative Council. Therefore, it may not have the power to pass every agenda it pleases, but it is allowed to cut off agendas from being seen by the whole school. Consequently, the representatives have a heavy duty to reflect not only their own opinion, but also that of the whole class. However, that role was not fulfilled, at least in the case of EOP Promoter policy. The Assembly of Representatives never approved the policy: only 27% agreed, 31.5% disagreed, and 45.5% gave up their votes. The majority of Assembly Representatives has to agree on a policy in order for it to pass. Ironically, the EOP Promoter policy is also one of the most approved policies from the Class Assembly this year with 89.5% of students approving of the policy. The clear difference in the result of the two assemblies demonstrates the inability of the Representatives to reflect the whole student body.

The EOP promoter policy, although unapproved in the Assembly of Representatives, was able to move on to the Class Assembly due to the decision of Lee Cho-Ah, the vice president of the 19th Legislative Council. While members of the Class Assembly have always stressed the importance of "abiding by school rules," they themselves were more than willing to bend rules for the policies they wanted to pass. She states that the representatives were not able to reflect the view of their whole class, with just a few representatives leading the discussion. The fault does not lie with those who are enthusiastic, but those who are unenthusiastic. As the discrepancy between representatives enlarges in terms of participation, those who do not join the discussion tend to vote according to the general atmosphere or just give up their votes. Kang Eun-Bin, the president of 20th Legislative Council states, “Usually we have fixed people speaking throughout the Assembly… And since the people who speak usually oppose the motion, lots of motions were denied.”

In the case of the EOP Promoter policy, it was not declined in the Assembly of Representatives because of high opposition, but rather due to votes that were "given up." When it comes to passing matters related to the Student Autonomous Rule, it requires the approval rate to be higher than 50%. Thus, if a vote is 'given up," it has the same effect as opposing the passing of the motion. This aspect increases the tendency for policies to be denied.

Responses to the problem included putting the Class Assembly at the beginning of the whole process. After the Class Assembly votes on a motion, the Assembly of Representatives will overlook the decision made. This was one of the pledges Jung Woo-Seok, the vice president of the 20th Legislative Council, made during his run. He said, “As the structure forces students outside of the Assembly of Representatives to be simply informed about certain issues, the change seemed necessary. The shift will also allow students to be more responsible and active.”

No matter which assembly comes first, though, the problem always lies in the low participation. The question of how to listen to what the students think can only really matter when an active voice to listen to exists. The so-called problems of the Assembly of Representatives are not simply methodological issues but mere shadows of a more fundamental flaw: too many students simply give up their votes. Speak out, KMLA! Then, at last, we will be able to ask with a clear conscience: how to listen?

TEACHER FEEDBACK:
A LONG WAY HERE, A LONG WAY TO GO

"We want better representation; we want better classes." Multiple student councils asked for a mid-term teacher feedback with those words. Our school has had a multiple-choice scoring teacher feedback at the end of each semester, but many found it insufficient in ensuring practical change. The 19th student council incorporated the idea of long-response feedbacks and the school finally put it into trial this semester. The students were warned in advance that this was only a trial. If things didn't go well here, the actual policy may never be implemented.

Although both were done anonymously, there were a few characteristics of the mid-term teacher feedback that differentiated it from the original teacher feedback. The mid-term teacher feedback was composed only of a long-response feedback rather than multiple-choice questions. The headmaster, along with a few other teachers, would read those comments, censor them, and then have a meeting with the teacher. Furthermore, it was optional, and thus, only those with a strong desire for change would have been strongly motivated to participate.

There were grounds for improvement in the first trial. Deputy Headmaster for Educational Planning Mr. Choi Kwan-Young uploaded a post about the mid-term teacher feedback on October 20th, but many students were not informed until 19th waver Lee Cho-Ah uploaded a notice on the school's Facebook group on October 23rd. Furthermore, the feedback was to end on October 25th, but the notice on the 19th wave Facebook group didn't specify the dates and there wasn't any notice on the 20th wave Facebook group. In fact, 42% of students answered to a survey that they did not participate due to a lack of time and opportunity.

What is of more concern, though, is that the quality of responses written may not have accurately reflected the opinions of students. The period of tests is a sensitive period for all, easily influenced by the outcome and results of exams. It would've been better if the feedback had been done with more time, and at a time when students were less busy, less influenced.

Another problem was regarding the format of the feedback. When students entered the feedback site, there wasn't a specific question or a prompt; students were simply expected to write their feedback in a big blank space. For one, this was intimidating and discouraging, but furthermore, students may not have known the specifics of what to write about that they simply threw around abstract ideas. In an interview with Mr. Choi, he claimed, "I was glad to see that there weren't any comments that aggressively attacked the teacher. However, comments like 'The class is boring' are so abstract that they did not help discuss the quality of class." Perhaps the form of the feedback could receive the blame for such abstract, non-specific comments.

Rather, it would've been better if the written response survey was kept, but done under separate categories like contents, delivery, evaluations, and so on. This would've made things easier for both the students expressing their opinions and the teachers trying to find relevant information out of such responses.

Although the mid-term survey has come a long way, a long path awaits it. Mr. Choi, after discussion amongst teachers, revealed that only two 18th wavers, nineteen 19th wavers, and fourteen 20th wavers had participated in the survey. Although we may be able to place the blame upon the timing of the survey or the format of the survey, more passion and more interest would've derived more participation regardless of the period or format. This policy can be successful with improvements on the period and format, but also with more participation coming from students.

The school is quite positive about the system, but is reluctant about making it last. Mr. Choi claimed, "The school thinks positively of the system and is willing to extend it in a few years. However, it would be even better if students could discuss these issues directly with the teacher based on an understanding of each teacher's philosophy, without speaking under anonymity." However, until the day comes when students are freed from peer pressure and fear of the teacher's authority, students will have to continue to remain under the mask of anonymity.

Han Ye-Joo
Junior editorialist, 20th Wave



"We want better representation; we want better classes."

GROWING, TRADITION

Once there was an old man who stood in front of the biggest tree in the town and told stories to young children. He always told grotesque stories, so everyone avoided him. Except on Halloween. Only on that special day would children and adults gather around the tree to listen to his stories. The old man couldn't see and couldn't run, but his stories always made it seem as if the old man was constantly being chased, seeing and running away from the horrible creatures of his stories. The old man barely moved while telling stories, but the way he told them somehow rocked him in his seat – sometimes violently and sometimes in calming paces. The old man died of a heart attack one day while telling yet another story to a dog that was passing by.

A funeral was supposed to have been held somewhere around the outskirts of town. No one came. Not even the old man's son. For a while, the town had one less source of amusement during Halloween. But Halloween was still fun. Children found new ways to entertain themselves when the old method disappeared. Halloween was still spooky, fun, and still there.

Few years later, another person took the old man's place. He was younger than the old man – he seemed to have barely gone through his forties. For the first few days, people crowded around the big tree even if it wasn't Halloween to see the man that had taken the old man's place. But the man never told any story. He just stared at the tree, and then at the children passing by, and then at the tree. When people lost interest and went back to their peaceful lives, the man started to tell stories. They were as grotesque and terrifying as the ones that the old man used to tell. Halloween soon found its old pace. The ritual of the whole town standing around the biggest tree listening to a man telling scary stories came back to life.

When the new man became old, he too greeted death all of a sudden. I heard that a large branch fell on his head and he just died right then and there. The other kids in town and I quickly started to think of new things to do on Halloween – we had forgotten what we did while the old man was gone.

But that turned out to be in vain. When Joe followed the lost football to the biggest tree, yet another new man greeted him with a creepy grin and a story that did not end even when Joe ran away from him. The next day, the brave kids in town marched up to the tree and sat in front of the new man, studying him. He kept on telling horrible stories like a broken record that didn't know how to stop- just like that old man back in those old days that died while telling one of his endless stories to a passing dog.

I went to the new man alone when everyone went back home after playing together. He was still rambling on, telling stories. I approached him, but I seemed to be no different from a stray dog to him.

"Why do you tell the stories?"

Miraculously, the man stopped. He stopped the story of a hallucination of a dead raven that followed a man in sleep every night; stopped mid-story. Instead, he seemed to be thinking.

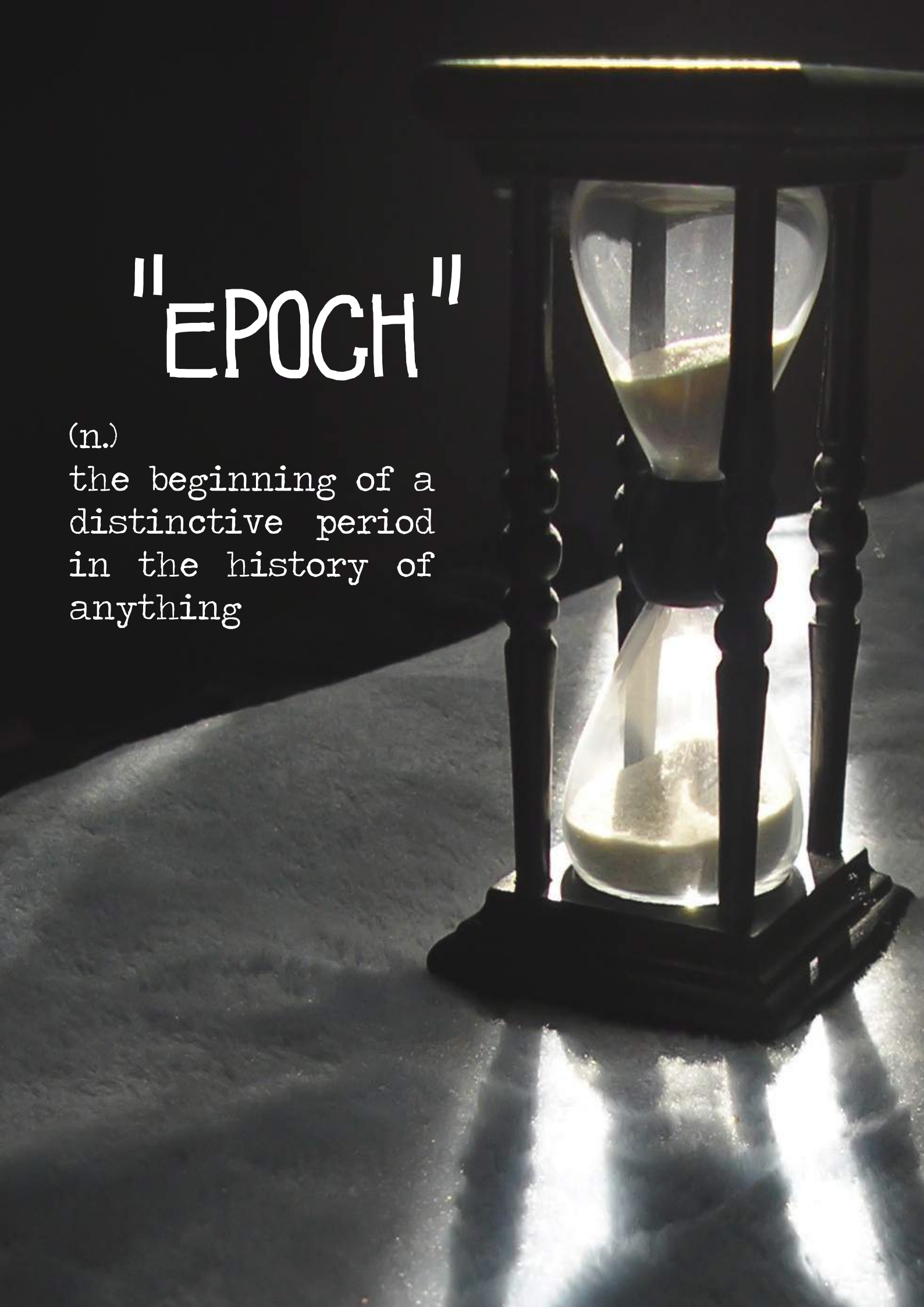
"I don't know."

Silence followed. The man did not tell stories. I half expected him to disappear into thin air, or die some sort of sudden death in front of me. Instead, he opened his mouth.

"Will you tell my story?"

I accepted. It was then that I stopped being a child.

Kim Hee-Jin, 20th Wave


"EPOCH"
(n.)
the beginning of a distinctive period in the history of anything